

The Gatekeeper Torus

The fleet had been expecting remnants of the Gatekeeper Alliance, but the active torus surprised them.

Attack: At the start of a space combat that includes this unit, reveal and resolve the top attack card.

Counter: When a player would research a technology, they may instead look at the top attack card and draw a card from the counter deck.

Movement: At the end of a tactical action in this system, if there are no ships in this system, move the ancients token to an adjacent system with the most total units; active player breaks ties.

ANCIENT UNIT

COMPLEXITY 





GATEKEEPER TORUS

ANCIENT WAR SUN

After a player activates this system, if there are fewer than 3 neutral fighters in this system, place neutral fighters until there are 3.

◆ SUSTAIN DAMAGE ◆ SPACE CANNON 4 (x4)

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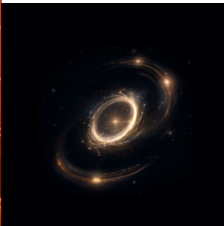
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SALVAGE

COMBAT

HULL



ENERGY FLECHETTES

ANCIENT ATTACK

Choose and destroy 6 fighters in this system.

The motes in the ancient hull stopped their motion and instead rose to the surface like bubbles, forming tiny darts of energy that speared out at the support ships.

PSYCHIC ARRAY

ANCIENT ATTACK

Replace two of your non-fighter ships with neutral units of the same type.

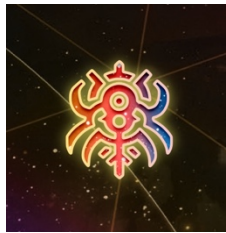
The surface of the ancient torus suddenly fragmented into a shimmering pattern of fractals and coiling spiral lights.

DIMENSIONAL SHEAR

ANCIENT ATTACK

Move the ancients token to the closest empty system. If there are none, place it in the closest system with the fewest ships; you break ties.

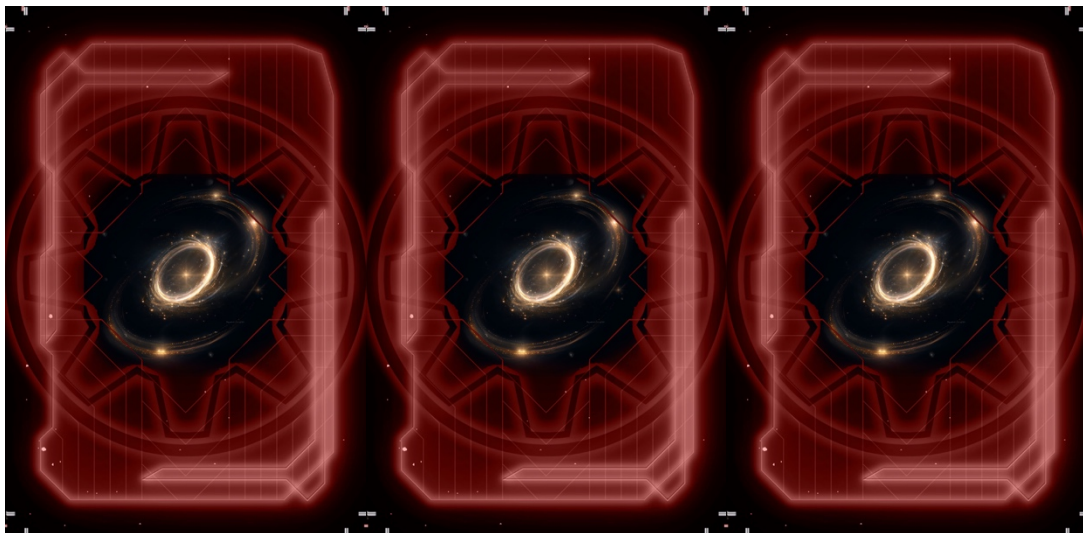
The torus blinked twice, then seemed to dissolve like foam.



Ancient unit rules adjustments:

- ◆ When setting up the ancient unit card, place commodities on that card equal to **HULL**.
- ◆ When a hit would be assigned to that unit, instead the active player gains a commodity from it.
- ◆ When that unit repairs, place a commodity on the unit card, up to its **HULL**.
- ◆ Once no commodities remain, draw salvage cards into your hand equal to the unit's **SALVAGE** value and purge this ancient's components.

v0.11



CORE BEAM

ANCIENT ATTACK

Remove the highest resource cost ship in this system.

A high-intensity beam of light speared the largest ship.

DEFENSIVE MATRIX

ANCIENT ATTACK

The ancient cancels 4 hits your ships produce this turn.

The torus spun rapidly, shedding tiny motes that refracted beams and intercepted missiles.

NEUTRON PULSE

ANCIENT ATTACK

Remove all ground forces in the space area of this system.

Then, remove all ground forces from the planet with the most ground forces in this or an adjacent system, if able.

The ancient torus pulsed once, then seemed to quieten. Comms fell silent.

MAGNETIC OVERLOAD

ANCIENT ATTACK

Your unit upgrade technology of the highest resource cost ship in this system is treated as blank until the end of this turn. That unit type cannot roll combat dice or use abilities this turn.

The ancient torus glowed dimly blue then seemed to fade peacefully.

MOTE SWARM

ANCIENT ATTACK

Place 6 neutral fighters in this system.

Deep lights pulsed in the torus, then gathered into molecular clumps and spat themselves into space.

SPIRAL LASH

ANCIENT ATTACK

Choose and destroy 4 ships in this system.

The torus flashed into a grid of lights and began to spin, slicing through the fleet.

HELICAL BEAM

ANCIENT ATTACK

One of your undamaged ships in this system with SUSTAIN DAMAGE becomes damaged.

Then, resolve SPACE CANNON 6 (x8) against your ships.

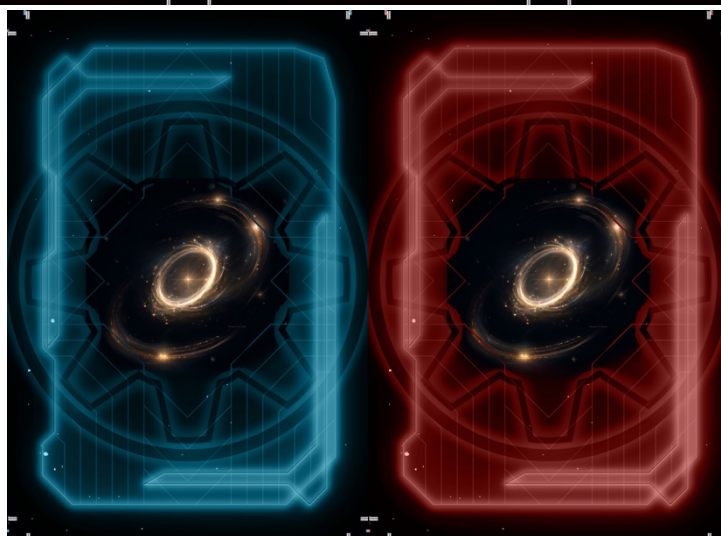
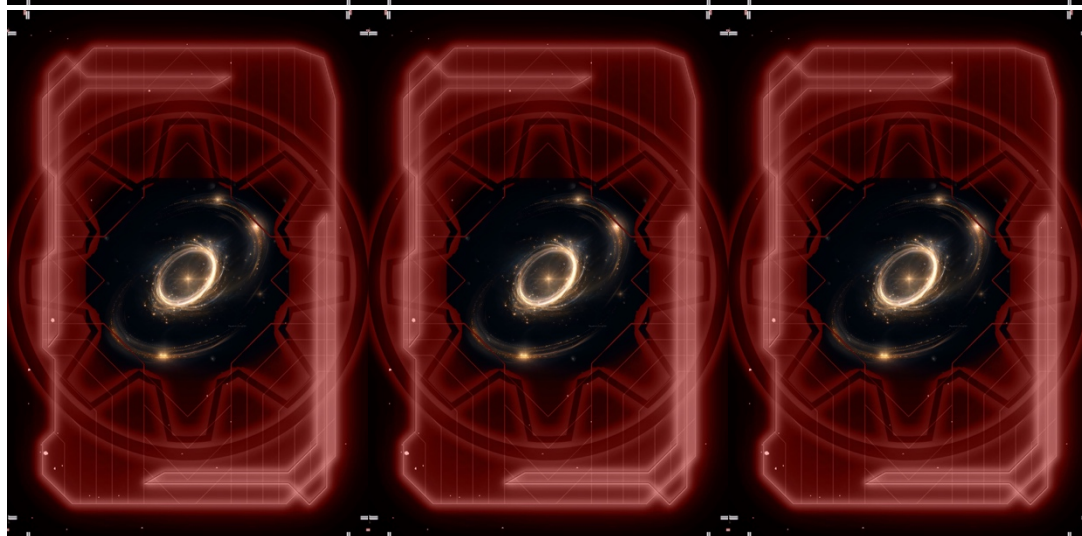
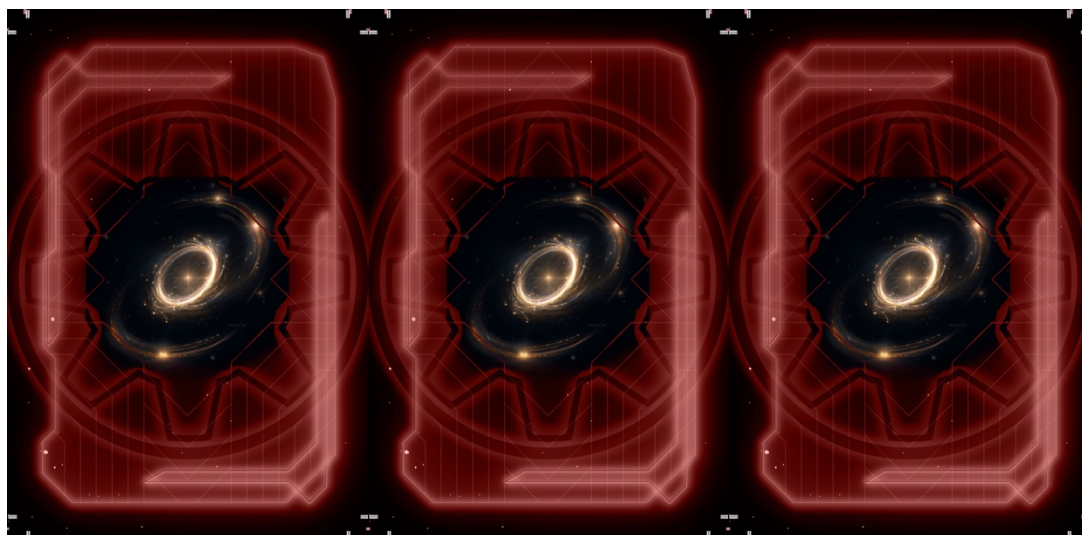
A double helix of pulsed light spiraled out towards the massed fleet.

SCATTERED TARGETS

COUNTER

When the ancient resolves an attack, you may discard this card. If you do, for every 2 ships in the system, you may cancel 1 hit produced by the ancient this turn.

The fleet spread wide, forcing the ancient torus to diffuse its powerful beam attack.



DECOY FLEET

COUNTER

Place this card in your play area at any time.

At the beginning of a round of space combat, choose 1 fighter for each non-fighter ship in this system. The ancient cannot assign hits to those fighters during this round of space combat.

The torus could not have known that the Mentak fleet did not expect to survive this engagement. This granted them a grim focus.



REFLECTIVE MIRRORS

COUNTER

When the ancient resolves an attack, you may discard this card and destroy 1 of your undamaged units with SUSTAIN DAMAGE in this system to produce 2 hits against the ancient.

The reflective shielding the Jol-Nar scientists installed only worked once, but the torus was pierced by the riposte.



REFRACTIVE MIRRORS

COUNTER

When the ancient resolves an attack, you may discard this card and destroy 1 of your undamaged units with SUSTAIN DAMAGE in this system to ignore the effects of that attack.

Cladding the dreadnoughts with prismatic shielding fractured the powerful beam weapon of the torus, absorbing the brunt of its attack.



OVERWHELMING SWARM

COUNTER

When the ancient resolves an attack, you may discard this card.

If you do, each of your fighters may have an additional hit assigned to them in the assign hits step during space combat this turn.

The strategy was brutal, but by concentrating all the fighters and swarming the ancient craft, each life lost counted for two.



DISRUPTING CHAFF

COUNTER

Place this card in your play area at any time.

Your destroyers may assign hits produced by their ANTI-FIGHTER BARRAGE to this ancient.

Clouds of debris and chaff surrounded the torus, diffusing its defenses and allowing the Argent fleet to strike true.



PEER COGNITION

COUNTER

Place this card in your play area at any time.

Your war suns ignore attack effects from this ancient.

Something about the fleet's greatest technological wonders kept the ancient craft from striking them down.



FOCUS FIRE

COUNTER

Place this card in your play area at any time.

Each of your cruisers rolls an additional combat die against this ancient.

Striking the same point on the glowing ancient torus seemed to puncture through its roiling translucent surface.



SARCOMAN MANEUVER

COUNTER

When 2 or more of your ships would be destroyed or removed by an ancient attack, you may discard this card to prevent 1 of those ships being destroyed or removed.

The ship's navigator had to hold until the final instant to dodge the beam, crying tears as her comrades died in the blast.



MAGNETIC PULSE

COUNTER

After the ancient uses SUSTAIN DAMAGE, you may discard this card to produce 2 additional hits.

After significant research, the Sol scientists determined that a magnetic pulse delivered at the perfect moment would deliver additional damage.



